

Non-Conformance Report Procedure

Purpose

This procedure defines the process for identifying, documenting, and resolving non-conformances in products, processes, or the quality management system.

Scope

This procedure applies to all non-conformances discovered during production, inspection, auditing, or customer feedback at Acme Corporation.

Definitions

NCR: Non-Conformance Report — a formal document that records a deviation from specified requirements.

Disposition: The action taken on a non-conforming product (use-as-is, rework, repair, scrap).

Root Cause: The underlying cause of a non-conformance.

Procedure

Step 1: Detection and Containment

When a non-conformance is detected (by operator, inspector, auditor, or customer):

1. Immediately stop production if the non-conformance affects product safety or critical parameters.
2. Quarantine affected products with a red “QUARANTINED” tag.
3. Notify the QA Supervisor within 30 minutes.
4. Do not move or process quarantined material until QA disposition.

Step 2: Initiate NCR

The QA Supervisor or QA Engineer initiates an NCR in the QMS system:

1. Open the NCR template in the QMS portal.
2. Record the following information:
 - Date and time of detection
 - Product name and batch/lot number
 - Quantity affected
 - Description of the non-conformance
 - Detected by (name and role)
 - Production line or area
3. Assign a unique NCR number (format: NCR-YYYY-XXXX).
4. Attach supporting evidence (photos, test results, inspection records).

Step 3: Evaluation and Disposition

The QA Engineer evaluates the non-conformance and determines disposition:

Use-as-is: The product meets functional requirements despite the deviation. Requires customer approval if applicable.

Rework: The product can be brought into conformance through additional processing. Issue rework instructions.

Repair: The product can be made functional but may not fully conform to original specifications. Requires customer approval.

Scrap: The product cannot be recovered. Document scrap disposition and quantity.

Step 4: Root Cause Analysis

For all NCRs requiring corrective action, perform root cause analysis using one of these methods:

- 5 Whys: Ask “why” five times to drill down to the root cause.
- Fishbone Diagram: Analyze potential causes across categories (Man, Machine, Material, Method, Measurement, Environment).
- Cause and Effect Matrix: Quantify the relationship between process inputs and outputs.

Document the root cause in the NCR form.

Step 5: Corrective Action

If the non-conformance requires systemic correction, initiate a CAPA per CAPA-004. The corrective action must address the root cause, not just the symptom.

Step 6: Verification

The QA department verifies the effectiveness of the corrective action within 30 days of implementation. If the action is ineffective, escalate to the QA Manager.

Step 7: Closure

The NCR is closed when:

- The disposition is completed
- Corrective action is verified effective
- All documentation is complete
- QA Manager approval is obtained

NCR Classification

Critical: Safety or regulatory non-conformance. Immediate escalation to QA Manager. CAPA mandatory.

Major: Non-conformance that affects form, fit, or function. CAPA generally required.

Minor: Non-conformance that does not affect form, fit, or function. CAPA at QA Engineer's discretion.

Related Documents

- CAPA-004: Corrective and Preventive Action Procedure
- WI-034: Production Line Pressure Monitoring
- WI-042: Visual Inspection Criteria for Finished Products

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